Request for Proposal: HR Service Delivery Platform

Issued by Kestrel Manufacturing Ltd (fictional) | Fictional document for classroom use

RFP at a glance

RFP title: HR Service Delivery Platform (RFP No. KML/HR/2026/014)

Issued by: Kestrel Manufacturing Ltd (fictional)

Industry: Manufacturing - enterprise HR technology (SaaS)

Summary: Kestrel wants one cloud platform where its 6,500 employees can find HR answers and raise HR requests, and where HR can manage cases against service levels, integrated with SAP SuccessFactors and Microsoft Entra ID.

Response deadline: 10 October 2026, 17:00 IST. Responses must be PDF, at most 10 pages.

1. Background

Kestrel Manufacturing employs about 6,500 people across four plants (Pune, Chennai, Hosur, Sanand) and a head office in Bengaluru. Around 70% are shift-based frontline employees without corporate laptops. HR queries today arrive through email, walk-ins and phone calls, with no tracking or service levels.

2. Key requirements

R1. Employee self-service portal usable on mobile, kiosk and desktop, in English and at least two Indian languages.

R2. HR case management with categories, SLA timers, escalation and confidential case handling.

R3. Policy knowledge base with search and article analytics.

R4. Integration with SAP SuccessFactors (employee master data) and Microsoft Entra ID (single sign-on).

R5. India data residency and compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023.

R6. Go-live across all sites within about 20 weeks of contract signature.

R7. Transparent three-year total cost of ownership.

3. Required response format

Suppliers must answer in these sections: (1) Executive summary; (2) Understanding of the requirement; (3) Proposed solution and architecture; (4) Implementation approach, timeline, team and milestones; (5) Commercial proposal with a price table and assumptions; (6) Security, compliance and risk controls; (7) Support model, relevant experience and references.

4. Evaluation criteria and weights

Each criterion is scored 0-10. Weighted scores determine the ranking; ties are broken by earlier submission date, then historical experience rating, then supplier name.

C1. Technical Capability (30%): architecture, integrations, scalability and technical fit to R1-R4.

Best practice: cloud-native platform with certified SuccessFactors connector, open APIs, SSO/SCIM, 99.9%+ availability and load testing well above 6,500 users.

C2. Implementation Plan (20%): timeline, milestones, staffing, governance and risk plan.

Best practice: phased plan with dated milestones and exit criteria, named team, a pilot site, a RAID log and hypercare, completed within 12-20 weeks.

C3. Commercial Value (20%): pricing clarity, three-year total cost, assumptions and exclusions.

Best practice: fixed or milestone-linked implementation fees, price locks and every assumption stated, with no open-ended estimates.

C4. Security and Compliance (20%): controls, certifications, privacy and auditability.

Best practice: current ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II, encryption, India hosting, DPDP processes, MFA, audit logs and independent penetration testing.

C5. Support and Experience (10%): support model, similar projects and references.

Best practice: 24x7 priority-1 support with service credits, a customer success manager and several referenceable implementations of similar size.

5. Commercial and legal notes

Prices in INR excluding GST. Kestrel may shortlist suppliers for demonstrations. This RFP is fictional and created for a classroom exercise.